BUSINESS PLAN SUMMARY

Apps for Change

Free Apps. Real Change. Community-Powered.

Prepared for funders by Sam, Executive Director · Version 4 · November 2026

At a glance

Apps for Change builds free, never-monetized well-being apps for everyday people. All four of our apps launch together on **February 17, 2027, Random Acts of Kindness Day,** and we are seeking about $12,500 for 2027 to launch them and help them reach the people who need them.

- **Who we are:** a Minnesota nonprofit corporation (EIN 41-4014098), tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3), led by founder and Executive Director Sam.
- **What we build:** four free apps for iOS and Android: Advocate's Compass, Goal Getter, Care About You, and Beat the Craving.
- **Our promise:** no subscriptions, no advertising, no in-app purchases, and no data sales. Our nonprofit structure removes any incentive to monetize users.
- **Where we are:** all four apps are ready and in final testing. They launch together on the App Store and Google Play on February 17, 2027, as our own act of kindness for Random Acts of Kindness Day.
- **Targets:** 2,500 downloads (stretch: 5,000) and 2 formal partner organizations in 2027, on the way to 5,000 downloads and 500 monthly active users in the apps' first year after launch.
- **The ask:** about $12,500 in grants, gifts, and in-kind support for 2027. A lean floor plan of about $6,000 still launches and supports all four apps.

The need

Many Minnesotans need practical, everyday support between appointments, and the apps that could help often come with a catch.

- **Speaking up in disability services.** More than 74,000 Minnesotans used the state's four disability waivers in 2024, each with recurring planning meetings about their services. Minnesota is also redesigning these waivers to add individual budgets and more self-direction, which means more decisions for people and families to make. (Minnesota House Research, 2025)
- **Staying in recovery.** About 876,000 Minnesotans age 12 and older (18.1%) had a substance use disorder in 2022 to 2023, above the national rate of 17.2% (KFF, from SAMHSA data). In 2025, 983 Minnesotans died of a drug overdose, nearly three every day (Minnesota Department of Health).
- **Staying connected.** In mid-2025, 21% of U.S. adults said they felt lonely a lot of the previous day, the highest rate since 2021. Among adults 30 to 44, it was 25%. (Gallup, 2025)
- **Tools with a catch.** Many well-being apps lock features behind subscriptions or are funded by advertising and user data. That model works against the people who most need help.

Our approach

We compete on trust: our apps are free, private, and shaped by the people who use them, and our nonprofit form keeps them that way.

- **Free, with no strings attached.** With no owners or shareholders, nothing pulls us toward paywalls, upsells, or ads. Crisis resources are never paywalled.
- **Privacy-first.** Data is stored securely in the cloud, never sold, never used for advertising, and never shared with partners or funders. Users can delete it at any time.
- **AI only on request.** Where an app offers AI help, it runs only when the user asks for it.
- **Community-powered.** Users help set the roadmap through virtual town halls written into our bylaws, plus private testing before launch and focus groups after it.
- **Built with lived experience.** People in recovery, self-advocates, and families test and shape each app, before launch and in every update after it.
- **Accessible from the start.** Each app is designed for screen readers, large text, and plain language, and reviewed with disabled users.

Programs

Each app runs as its own program, with its own audience, outcomes, and measures. All four launch together on February 17, 2027, and each then gets a season of focused outreach.

App	What it does	Who it serves	Season of focus after launch
Advocate's Compass	Self-advocacy lessons, plain-language scripts for real conversations (generated on request), and a meeting tracker for prep, notes, and follow-ups	People with disabilities and families navigating waiver services, and anyone who needs to speak up for themselves	ADA anniversary (July) and IEP season (August and September)
Goal Getter	Turns goals across twelve life areas into action steps and milestones, with a progress dashboard	Millennial adults working on personal, career, and financial goals	Self-Improvement Month (September) and New Year 2028
Care About You	Plans acts of kindness for others and for yourself, and puts each one on your calendar	Elderly adults who want to feel more connected	Launch week, then World Kindness Day (November 13) and the giving season
Beat the Craving	Builds a personal set of coping strategies, with days-in-recovery and cravings-beaten counters, trigger notes that reveal patterns, and a button to call or find AA. Fully manual, with no AI	Adults in early recovery from alcohol, nicotine, or other drugs, on any recovery path	National Recovery Month (September), through recovery partners

Beat the Craving complements treatment and peer support. It is not a treatment program and makes no clinical claims.

Launch: Our Act of Kindness

We chose Random Acts of Kindness Day for launch because it says what Apps for Change is about: our act of kindness is four free apps, with no strings attached, for anyone who wants them. We then ask everyone who gets one to pass it on to someone who could use it.

- **One date, one story.** Partners, press, and supporters share one launch instead of four, during Random Acts of Kindness Week (February 14 to 20, 2027).
- **A careful release.** All four apps are submitted to Apple and Google by January 27 and held after approval, so they can go live together on launch morning.
- **Launch night.** Our first community town hall, the evening of February 17, gives a live tour of all four apps.
- **Launch targets:** 150 people on our "Get it first" list before launch, 250 downloads in launch week, and at least two partner organizations sharing on launch day.

Community town halls

Our virtual town halls start on launch night, February 17, 2027, and then meet quarterly on May 18, August 17, and November 16.

- **Written into our bylaws.** Article VI, Section 6.8 makes town halls part of governance: what people share is summarized and presented to the Board.
- **What changed because of you.** After launch night, each 45-minute session shows what changed in the apps because of user ideas, and takes a closer look at one app.
- **Your ideas, answered.** Attendees bring ideas for new features and new apps. Every idea is logged, scored, reported to the Board, and answered within two weeks.
- **Open to everyone.** Sessions have live captions, phone dial-in, and accommodations on request, and are never recorded.
- **2027 goal:** 25 people on launch night, 10 or more at each later town hall, and at least three changes per app that came from community feedback.

2027 goals and milestones

All four apps are live from February 17, 2027, so the rest of the year is about reaching the people they were built for and improving them with users.

- **Launch:** all four apps live on the App Store and Google Play on February 17, 2027
- **Downloads:** 2,500 across the four apps by December 2027 (stretch: 5,000)
- **Website and online giving:** redesigned appsforchange.org by January 2027
- **Co-design and access:** an accessibility review of each app before launch, and four focus groups (one per app) in the spring and summer to shape the first updates
- **Partners:** two formal partners, one life coaching organization and one disability advocacy organization
- **East Metro pilot:** an Advocate's Compass pilot with East Metro partners, with at least half of participants living in Dakota, Ramsey, or Washington County. Timing and size will be set with East Metro partners and funders in spring 2027.

Measuring impact

Each program tracks one core outcome and a reach target for its first year after launch (February 2027 to February 2028); together, the four apps target 5,000 downloads and 500 monthly active users.

Program	Outcome we work toward	Key first-year measure	First-year reach
Advocate's Compass	People walk into meetings prepared and voice their own priorities	75% of users rate their latest meeting 4 or 5 for feeling prepared, in their own meeting notes	1,500 downloads, 150 monthly users
Goal Getter	Goals turned into action and achieved	50% of active users complete a milestone within 90 days	1,000 downloads, 100 monthly users
Care About You	More kindness, less loneliness	50% of Impact Panel members who start with a low score improve on AFC's Connection and Kindness Check	1,000 downloads, 100 monthly users
Beat the Craving	More cravings managed without a return to use	70% of logged cravings marked as managed without use	1,500 downloads, 150 monthly users

Counted, not asked. Usage outcomes come from app data and are counted automatically as totals. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions. Advocate's Compass users can rate each meeting in their own notes, and nothing prompts them to.

The AFC Impact Panel. Well-being and other self-reported outcomes come from adults who choose to join our Impact Panel through a link in each app's Settings or on our website. Members answer a short email survey when they join and again at 3 and 12 months, using five short checks AFC wrote itself, so every question can be shown to funders, partners, and town hall attendees. In return, they get their own well-being snapshot, first access to new features, early results, and, if they want it, recognition in our impact report.

Reported with care. We report only totals and never show results for groups smaller than 10. Panel members, town hall guests, and workshop participants can share their county of residence, so we can report to community foundations by the areas they serve. Starting in 2028, an annual impact report goes to users, funders, and our Board, and we plan a formal evaluation with a Minnesota university or independent partner by 2029.

Marketing and outreach

Our 2027 marketing plan builds everything around the February 17 launch. It prioritizes app users, then partners, then donors, on a $500 budget and three to five hours a week, starting in Minnesota and reaching everyone else online.

- **One launch, one story.** Our "Our Act of Kindness" campaign starts in January with a "Get it first" list and a four-week countdown that gives each app a week in the spotlight, then launches all four during Random Acts of Kindness Week.
- **Free reach before paid.** We approved for Google Ad Grants, up to $10,000 a month in free search ads, and pairing it with an op-ed and launch press outreach, LinkedIn posts, and helpful answers in local online groups, all drawing on our Executive Director's years in Minnesota human services.
- **Partners who already serve our users.** Disability and self-advocacy organizations for Advocate's Compass, volunteer centers for Care About You, coaches for Goal Getter, and recovery

organizations for Beat the Craving each get a launch-day share kit. Beat the Craving is promoted only through partners and organic channels.

- **After launch, a season for each app.** The ADA anniversary and IEP season for Advocate's Compass, Self-Improvement Month for Goal Getter, National Recovery Month for Beat the Craving, and World Kindness Day for Care About You.
- **Many small donors.** Asks stay light until the November giving days and a year-end appeal, with a $10 monthly giving option all year. A broad donor base also helps us meet the IRS public support test.
- **Careful, accessible messaging.** We check every claim against our privacy policy, make no health claims, name partners only once they agree in writing, and provide captions, alt text, and large print.
- **2027 targets:** 2,500 downloads (stretch: 5,000), 400 newsletter subscribers, 40 donors, 3 partners sharing our apps, 2 published op-eds, and 1,000 website visits a month by late 2027.

Leadership and governance

A three-member Board governs AFC, and the organization's governance documents are already written.

- **Sam, Founder, Executive Director, and Board Chair.** Brings director-level and frontline experience in Minnesota disability waiver programs (CADI, BI, DD, and Housing Support) and a B.A. in Individualized Studies from Metropolitan State University.
- **Joe, Chief Change Engineer and Board Secretary.** Directs engineering and data work professionally, and builds the apps with Sam.
- **Lynn, Chief People Officer and Treasurer.** Oversees financial records, controls, and IRS filings, and reports at each regular Board meeting.
- **Governance documents.** Bylaws and conflict-of-interest, whistleblower, and document-retention policies aligned with Minnesota Statutes Chapter 317A, plus a Privacy Policy and Terms of Service, both reviewed by an attorney before launch. A Board roster is available on request.
- **Capacity.** We run lean: the Executive Director gives about 10 hours a week and the Lead Developer about 10 hours a month, supported by Google for Nonprofits.
- **Tax status.** AFC is tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3). By December 1, 2026, we will file IRS Form 8940 to update our classification to a public charity, matching how AFC operates.

Financial plan

Our 2027 plan is deliberately lean: $12,500 in planned spending, with a $5,853 floor that still launches and supports all four apps.

Use of funds, 2027	Target	Floor
Legal review (governance, Terms of Service, privacy)	$2,500	$1,000
Insurance (cyber & general liability)	$3,000	$2,500
Accounting and bookkeeping	$1,000	$500
Focus groups and community research	$1,600	$800
Marketing and outreach	$2,500	$500
AI tools (in-app & for operations)	$1,200	$240
Office & Administration	$450	$300
Website and hosting	$250	$13
Total	**$12,500**	**$5,853**

Planned support of $12,500 (floor: $6,000) comes from foundation grants, individual gifts, corporate and matching gifts, and in-kind help, so the Target plan breaks even and the floor plan ends the year with a small surplus ($147). The plan includes no salaries or paid development. Most legal review costs fall in December 2026 and January 2027, before launch.

Beyond 2027, we will grow a broad base of individual donors alongside foundation support. Any future earned revenue, such as licensing curriculum to other organizations, would need Board approval and would never charge app users.

Looking ahead

We start in Minnesota, but our apps are free to anyone, anywhere, and the long-term opportunity reaches well beyond the state.

Longer term, an optional, privacy-preserving way for users to support one another could deepen results across all four programs. Because shared content brings new safety duties, this community layer is gated: it moves forward only with dedicated funding, legal review, a Trust and Safety plan, and Board approval. Each 2027 town hall asks users whether they want it and what would make it feel safe.

Partner with us

Grants and gifts of any size keep the apps free, and larger investments expand what each program can deliver.

Investment	What it makes possible
Launch support	Store, legal, and outreach costs for the February 17 launch of all four apps
Contract development hours	Faster, steadier updates and fixes after launch
Paid accessibility testing	Stipends so disabled testers are paid for their expertise
Lived-experience focus groups	Stipends for people in recovery, self-advocates, and families who help shape the apps
Evaluation tools and partner	Survey tools in 2027 and an independent evaluation partner by 2029
Outreach and workshops	Self-advocacy workshops, recovery-center outreach, partner training, and the East Metro pilot

We also welcome in-kind help, such as pro bono legal or accounting review, accessibility expertise, and design.

Contact: Sam, Executive Director · sam@appsforchange.org · appsforchange.org

Sources

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- Random Acts of Kindness Week 2027 dates (February 14 to 20): awarenessdays.com